

Depending on the virtualization software you're using, you can create multiple snapshots at various points. You'll then be able to return to any of these moments, effectively making you feel like you've gone back in time. You can also use snapshots for creating a single virtual machine and configuring it for various purposes, each in one snapshot of its own. It can also be used for tracking your progress at multiple stages by creating a new snapshot at every new stage so that you could revert back to a previous stage if you needed to undo something you did but don't remember what it was.

Snapshots can save you lots of time and quite a lot of work as well. Let's take an example: Let's suppose you want to install Ubuntu Linux for doing web development works. Now you don't want to install a new operating system, so you decide to install a virtualization software for the purpose. You happen to select VirtualBox for the same. Now, you install the latest version of Ubuntu inside VirtualBox, as a virtual machine (a VM, for short). You take a snapshot at this point to ensure that you don't have to install the operating system again. You name this snapshot as "Installed Ubuntu". Next, you install all the required software on it to prepare the operating system for your development works. You test everything and find that things are working well! You take another snapshot at this point and name it as "Ready for Web Development" and save it so that you don't have to install web development software like the web server, the IDE and the database later on, even if something goes wrong. You make a few pages and are satisfied that things are working fine. So you take another snapshot and call it "Started developing". The very next day you find that a new version of the database you're using has been released. With excitement, you perform the update and find that things aren't working well.

What do you do in a moment like this? You have a few options:

1. Create a new virtual machine, install Ubuntu Linux on it again, then download and install the software required for web development.
2. Revert to the "Installed Ubuntu" snapshot where Ubuntu was installed but the required software wasn't. Then you can download and install the software again.
3. Revert to "Ready for Web Development" snapshot where Ubuntu and the required software for your work was installed inside the virtual machine. You only have to continue the development work from scratch.
4. Revert to the "Started developing" snapshot where the operating system and the required software were installed and you had also created some web pages after some elbow grease.